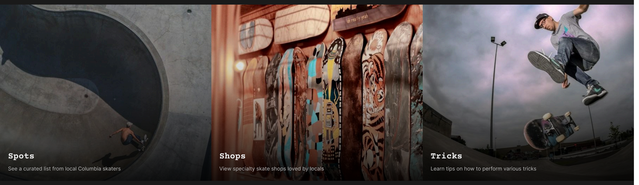
SKATE COLUMBIA

Home Spots Shops Tricks

YOUR COMPLETE GUIDE TO SKATEBOARDING IN COLUMBIA



Spots
See a curated list from local Columbia skaters

Shops
View specialty skate shops loved by locals

Tricks
Learn tips on how to perform various tricks

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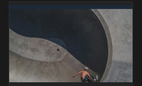
SKATE SPOTS

A curated list of the best spots in Columbia, SC.

ALL PARK STREET

Owens Field PARK
ADVANCED
Large concrete park with bowls, ledges, and a street section. Well-maintained and popular with locals.
1351 JIM HAMILTON BOULEVARD, COLUMBIA, SC



Irmo Skate Park PARK
INTERMEDIATE
Classic granite ledge spot in the Vista district. Perfect wax buildup from years of skaters.
CASTATE ST & HAGOOD ST, COLUMBIA, SC

Russel House STREET
INTERMEDIATE
Long marble banks alongside the university buildings. Great for carving and manual lines.
QUEENS ST, COLUMBIA, SC

Close Hipp STREET
BEGINNER
Chill neighborhood ledges with smooth pavement. Easy to get a session in before the restaurants open.
GARDEN ST & DEVINE ST, COLUMBIA, SC

T-Coop Fountain STREET
ADVANCED
Massive 8-stair gap with rough landing. Not for the faint of heart — locals say it eats boards.
HULL ST, COLUMBIA, SC

Gambrell STREET
ALL LEVELS
Outdoor concrete park by the river. Includes a mini ramp, a spine, and several street obstacles.
3765 BOSS RIVER RD, COLUMBIA, SC

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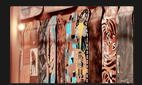
SKATE SHOPS

Specialty skate shops loved by locals.



Bluetile Skate Shop DECKS, HARDWARE
Columbia's original core skate shop. Riders on the team, deep deck selection, and genuine community energy.
2716 DEVINE ST, COLUMBIA, SC
Mon-Sat 11am-7pm

Salty's Board Shop CRUISERS, PARTS
Great shop for buying complete, good quality cruiser boards. Also a great shop to buy pads.
2400 FOREST DR, COLUMBIA, SC
Mon-Fri 10AM-6PM, SAT 10AM-4PM

Grindhouse Skate Shop APPAREL, ART DECKS
A small business recently established skate shop ran by locals. Has a large supply of used clothes and boards.
1410 MAIN ST, COLUMBIA, SC
10:00-7PM 12PM-7PM

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TRICKS

Learn how to perform various skateboarding tricks.

ALL BEGINNER INTERMEDIATE ADVANCED

Ollie BEGINNER
The foundation of all skateboarding. Pop the tail, slide your front foot up, and level the board in the air.

Kickflip INTERMEDIATE
Ollie with a flick off the heel-side toe to spin the board 360° on its long axis. The first real milestone.

Heelflip INTERMEDIATE
Like a kickflip but the board flips toe-side. Flick off the heel edge with your front foot going outward.

50-50 Grind BEGINNER
Lock both trucks onto a ledge or rail and slide. The entry-level grind — learn this before any other.

Nose Grind ADVANCED
Balance the front truck only on the obstacle with the tail kicked up. Requires precise weight distribution.

Tre Flip ADVANCED
Pop a kickflip while scooping the tail to spin the board 360° backside. Also called a 360 flip.

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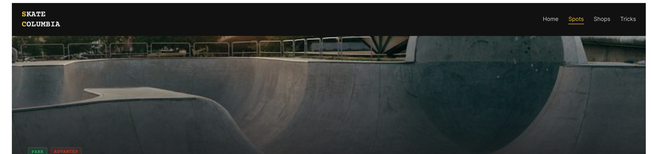

PARK ADVANCED

Owens Field Skate Park

← ALL SPOTS

★★★★☆ 4 / 5 local rating

Owens Field Skate Park is the best park in the area. Featuring a large flatground section with a downrail, the park flows into a central line requiring good pumping skills to complete. This is an advanced park, with three large bowls in the back of the park. Owens Field Skate Park has a lot to give for beginners, but becomes appreciated more and more as skill level advances.

LOCAL TIPS

01 Best sessions are late at night, there are plenty of people and it's well lit.
02 Watch your stuff late at night, little kids tend to steal stuff.
03 The bowls are intense, be confident before dropping in.
04 After the park gate closes, you can park in the tennis lot and walk over.

BEST FOR

ADVANCED BOWL SKATING
BANKS NIGHT SESSIONS

LOCATION

1351 Jim Hamilton Boulevard, Columbia, SC

IRMO SKATE PARK →

SKATE COLUMBIA

Home Spots Shops Tricks

HARDGOODS, LOCALS' PICK

Bluetile Skate Shop

← ALL SHOPS

Bluetile has been in Columbia for over 20 years, with a new location in Charleston established last year. Bluetile is ran by a team of very passionate, down to Earth people who go the extra mile to help people skate. They often give away free stickers, decks, and sometimes completes. They also run events and host competitions at local parks. Bluetile is the best skate shop in Columbia.

BRANDS CARRIED

REAL ANTI-HERO BAKER HEROIN SPITFIRE INDEPENDENT

SERVICES

BOARD BUILDS HIRE AN RELGARDS
WHEEL SWAPS FREQUENT COMPETITIONS

INFO

2716 Devine St, Columbia, SC

HOURS
Mon–Sat 11am–7pm

(803) 555-0142

INSTAGRAM
@bluetile

SALTY'S BOARD SHOP →

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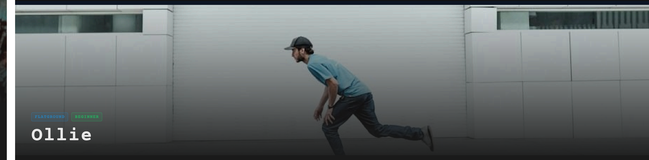

FLATGROUND BEGINNER

Ollie

← ALL TRICKS

The ollie is the single most important trick in skateboarding. Almost every other trick is built on the mechanics of the ollie. Invented on vert by Alan 'Ollie' Gelfand in 1978 and on flatground by Rodney Mullen in 1982, it works through a combination of tail pop and front foot drag that levels the board in the air without your hands. Once your ollie is consistent and clean, the rest of skateboarding opens up.

PREREQUISITES

BASIC RIDING AND PUSHING COMFORTABLE STOPPING CONSISTENT BALANCE ON THE BOARD

HOW TO DO IT

1 Place the ball of your foot in the middle of the tail, with your weight mostly on the front foot. Front foot sits behind the front bolts.
2 Bend your knees and jump, snapping the tail down hard against the ground at the end of it.
3 As the tail hits, drag your front foot up toward the nose, leveling the board.
4 Suck your knees up to your chest like Spider-Man to give the board room to rise beneath you.
5 Land with both feet over the bolts and absorb the impact by bending your knees.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Slamming the tail in the ground, it's more like dribbling a basketball, not stomping the tail.
- Jumping too early before the tail hits the ground.
- Front foot not dragging high enough, resulting in a rocketed ollie.
- Landing with feet too close together, aim for shoulder-width.

KICKFLIP →